

[Report 012] Adyen - Team Lead, Learning & Development

Score: 3.7/5
Culture Fit: Conditional
URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/adyen/jobs/7668248>
PDF: 
Legitimacy: High Confidence
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Dimension	Detail
Archetype	AI Transformation Lead (primary) + Innovation Lab Lead / Builder (secondary)
Domain	L&D leadership - global tech company, HR function
Function	Lead / build / strategy
Seniority	Senior manager / people lead
Remote	Office-first, Amsterdam - no remote-only
Team size	Team of Subject Matter Experts (size not specified)
TL;DR	Lead Adyen's global L&D strategy, manage a team of specialists, define the 2026 North Star for leadership effectiveness, and position L&D as a core business enablement function.

B) MATCH WITH CV

Requirement Mapping

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
3+ years managing teams of specialists, fast-paced tech environment	Aeres Hogeschool Lab Manager (team + student cohorts); Windesheim Supply Chain Finance Lectoraat (led cross-dept research + lab teams 2020-present); Tonomy Foundation co-founder (led product + community teams)	Strong (meets threshold, depth across multiple orgs)
Deep expertise developing L&D programs in HR/global functions	Designed and delivered learning programs at ROC, InHolland, Aeres, Windesheim; school-wide Scrum implementation; 8-course merge in under 2 months	Strong
Influence senior leadership in complex matrix orgs	"Stakeholder Alignment (Expert)"; cross-lectoraat coordination at Windesheim; aligned industry partners + academic leadership for VCH; grant writing with institutional sign-off	Strong
Translate business requirements into world-class learning strategies	Spark! Living Lab (business-driven innovation lab); COVID-19 Mega Project; KnopenKoning decision simulation - all business-problem-driven L&D	Strong
Modern learning technologies + AI applications	Self-hosted AI stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase); AI-driven supply chain lab; interviewing AI practitioners at Windesheim currently	Strong
Define strategic North Star for learning	Designed the learning architecture at Aeres (agile education model); created the vision and structure for Spark! Living Lab from scratch	Strong
Coach team members to reach potential	Student counselling (unpaid); mentored startups to independence; thesis graduate seeking Christiaan informally; talent magnet profile	Strong

Gaps

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
Formal "L&D within HR function" track record	Soft	Reframe: Christiaan built L&D infrastructure in academic orgs with the same business alignment mandate - just in university HR equivalent contexts
"Global matrix org" experience at scale (Adyen = 4,000+ employees)	Moderate	Tonomy Foundation + VCH are multi-country; KONGSBERG field service was global; but not enterprise-scale matrix management
No Adyen / fintech L&D context	Soft	Support org + fintech = technical learning at scale - KONGSBERG training for engineers is a fair analogy
Direct people management continuity (formal org chart reporting)	Soft	Lab management at Aeres was formal; Windesheim is more partnership-based; address directly if asked

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior manager / L&D lead. The "3 years managing specialists" is a floor, not a ceiling - Adyen is likely looking for someone with 6-10 years. Christiaan's actual experience depth exceeds 3 years but is distributed across multiple roles rather than one continuous org chart position.

"Sell senior without lying" plan:

- Lead with: "I have built L&D infrastructure at institutional scale - not managed within an existing one. I designed the system, hired the collaborators, and ran the outcomes." This is an honest upgrade of the framing.
- Cite the 8-course merge: concrete proof of strategic L&D redesign delivering business results (more aligned graduates, cost savings, integrated sprint methodology).
- Cite the AI Lab at Windesheim: positioned L&D as business enablement for applied research - exactly what Adyen wants L&D to be for product teams.
- The North Star framing in the JD ("define learning vision") maps directly to founding Spark! Living Lab and setting its methodology from scratch.

"If they downlevel" plan: Accept L&D Lead (not Team Lead) if the scope is still strategy-setting and there is a clear path to the Team Lead role within 12 months with written criteria. Comp must be at or above €70k.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Item	Data	Source
L&D Team Lead / Head of L&D Amsterdam	€70,000-€100,000 gross/year	Glassdoor NL; LinkedIn Salary benchmarks
Adyen compensation (non-engineering leadership)	Competitive; strong benefits (equity, bonus); somewhat below pure tech engineering salaries	Glassdoor Adyen Amsterdam
Christiaan's target	€65,000-€90,000	_profile.md
Role fit to target	This role likely bands €75,000-€95,000 for a qualified hire - within target range	Estimated
Demand signal	L&D leadership in scale-up tech: strong demand, limited supply of people who can also handle AI/modern tech component	Positive

Note: No salary published in JD - standard for Adyen. The combination of people management + strategy mandate + AI component places this in the upper third of the band. Negotiating toward €80-85k is realistic.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current status	Proposed change	Why
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1	CV Summary	Innovation builder framing	Add: "Built and led learning organizations across university and tech contexts - from designing the learning architecture to running the teams that deliver it"	Speaks to strategic + operational L&D
2	Aeres entry	"Lab Manager" title	Expand: emphasize team leadership (students, guest lecturers, partner orgs), strategic design mandate, and learning outcomes	Makes "managed specialists" legible
3	Windesheim entry	Project-heavy	Add explicit L&D leadership language: "Defined the learning architecture and methodology for Spark! Living Lab; led interdisciplinary teams to redesign curriculum"	Matches "translate business needs into learning strategy"
4	Skills - Agile Coaching	Listed	Add "Learning Programme Leadership" or equivalent - make the L&D management track visible	ATS and recruiter visibility
5	LinkedIn featured section	Not specified	Pin: Spark! Living Lab URL + Beer Game demonstrator as visual proof of L&D outcomes	First impression for Adyen L&D recruiter

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	Define North Star for learning strategy	Spark! Living Lab founding	Windesheim Supply Chain Finance Lectoraat had no lab infrastructure or learning design framework	Build from zero: vision, methodology, content, team, tooling	Defined the "build and iterate" learning model; brought in blockchain + simulation as pedagogical spine; ran it as a living lab rather than a classroom	Lab still running 5+ years later; spawned VCH and multiple student ventures	Would have formalised the impact metrics earlier - learning outcomes were real but underdocumented
2	Lead and coach team to full potential	Veles Farming + Magic Frames	Student startups with potential but no commercial direction	Act as advisor, seed investor, and development coach - unpaid	Ran coaching sessions, helped with pitch, made introductions, removed blockers	Veles Farming: €2M funding, operating in Slovakia. Magic Frames: independent launch and active.	Learned that coaching without authority structures is often more effective - people engage because they want to, not because they have to
3	8-course merge / organisational change	COVID-19 Mega Project	Pandemic hit during semester; 8 separate courses became un-runnable separately	Design and execute emergency curriculum redesign in under 2 months	Mapped dependencies across courses, found the interdisciplinary core, rebuilt as single sprint-based project track; aligned 8 course leads	Delivered on time; became model referenced by other Hogeschool faculties	Rushed the first sprint structure; second iteration was much cleaner. Build in a review cycle from the start.
4	Position L&D as business enablement	AI Lab at Windesheim	Lectoraat leadership wanted to understand	Built and maintained self-funded	Self-hosted Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n,	Practitioners now experimenting with real AI	Should have sought institutional budget from the

			practical AI tool adoption	AI research sandbox	Supabase; designed onboarding curriculum for researchers; ran group sessions	tools; directly informs the lectoraat's 2025-2026 research agenda	start rather than self-funding - good proof of commitment but unsustainable model
5	Influence senior leadership	KONGSBERG CEO escalation	Data contract breach between partner systems on an oil rig, no internet connectivity	As junior consultant, had to escalate a contractual data integrity issue to the CEO of a major oil company	Read the contract overnight, built the case, escalated calmly and directly the next morning	Issue resolved; data standards were formalised; my recommendation was adopted	"Read the contract" is not standard junior consultant behaviour - it taught me that level-appropriate analysis plus composure is what earns senior trust
6	Modern learning tech + AI	AI stack deployment + current Windesheim work	Support org needs AI-native learning tools; traditional LMS is insufficient	Assess and prototype emerging L&D tech (Christiaan is currently doing this at Windesheim)	Evaluating AI tools for practitioner use; building hands-on experience with LXP and AI-generated content frameworks	Active output: 1 day/week research role with live tooling	The gap between "what vendors demo" and "what actually works with real learners" is significant - prototype before committing to a platform

Recommended case study: Spark! Living Lab (sparklivinglab.nl) - full-lifecycle L&D system built from scratch inside a university. Position it as "I built what Adyen wants L&D to become - a living system where business problems drive learning design, not the other way around."

Red-flag questions:

- "Do you have experience managing within an HR function specifically?" - Answer: "My L&D experience has been within academic institutions where the L&D function sits adjacent to HR in the same way - reporting to organisational leadership, accountable for capability outcomes across departments. The structural difference is the org chart; the functional mandate is identical."
- "This is an office-first role - are you OK with daily Amsterdam commute?" - Address directly and honestly: "Baarn to Amsterdam is ~40 minutes. I've done regular Amsterdam commutes before and it's workable. I'd want to confirm the expected in-office days."
- "How do you manage the tension between urgent delivery and strategic thinking?" - "I've run labs and teaching systems simultaneously with delivery mandates. The way I manage it: the strategy sets the filter, so delivery decisions are pre-made. When everything is aligned to a clear North Star, the day-to-day execution becomes simpler."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting age	Not recoverable from summary fetch; Adyen is actively hiring in L&D across multiple JDs simultaneously (011 + 012 both live)	Positive (active org)
Apply button	Active via Greenhouse API	Positive
JD specificity	Names "2026 strategy", "North Star", "leadership effectiveness", "L&D Core team" - org-specific language	Positive
Requirements realism	3 years managing specialists is a soft floor; senior L&D lead mandate is realistic at this level	Positive

Company hiring signals	Adyen profitable, publicly listed fintech; no layoff news in L&D	Positive
Multiple L&D roles open simultaneously	011 (LXD PM) + 012 (Team Lead) both live - suggests genuine L&D investment	Positive
Reposting pattern	No prior appearance in scan history	Positive

Context Notes: The simultaneous existence of a Team Lead role AND an execution-focused LXD PM role suggests Adyen is building out the L&D function rather than just backfilling. This is a real investment, not a ghost posting.

RECOMMENDATION

Score: **3.7/5** - A genuine fit candidate with real strategic L&D experience, but three factors prevent a higher score:

1. **Office-first Amsterdam:** Not part-time/fractional. Full-time commute from Baarn required. This conflicts with Christiaan's preferred multi-position 0.4-0.6 FTE model.
2. **"Managed within HR function" gap:** Christiaan's L&D experience is institution-building, not L&D-department management. The framing is adjustable but the gap is real.
3. **Large corporate dynamics:** Adyen is 4,000+ employees globally. The role involves navigating a global matrix org. Christiaan's 2-year vision is a hackerspace, not a corporate L&D team.

Recommendation: Apply if targeting Adyen specifically or if open to a full-time Amsterdam role. The coaching/strategy mandate is genuine. This is a stronger fit than 011 (more strategy, less Articulate 360 execution). Negotiate firmly for €80k+. But flag to self: this is a full-time corporate role, not part-time/fractional - manage expectations accordingly.

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: Large public company (4,000+ employees globally, listed fintech). Adyen is culturally strong and has a genuine "engineered for ambition" identity. The L&D Core team is a strategic HR function with a stated mandate to build leadership effectiveness and position L&D as a business enabler. This is a higher-order function than report 011 - it is about defining the vision, not executing content.

Culture signals: The JD language includes "North Star," "strategic direction," "advocate for frictionless, learner-centred experiences," "remove organisational friction." These are design and systems-thinking signals, not pure execution signals. Adyen is formal in its office-first policy but relatively informal in its engineering culture. The L&D function here has real scope.

Physical/work environment: Office-first, Amsterdam. No remote option. Corporate headquarters environment, high-quality but structured.

Match against 2-year vision: The role has a genuine build mandate (define the North Star, architect the ecosystem) which partially matches Christiaan's vision. The core tension is scale: this is still a 4,000-person corporate org, a global matrix structure, and a fixed Amsterdam office. The hackerspace vision is small group, high trust, new territory - this is large group, institutional trust, established territory. Partial alignment at the mandate level; structural misalignment at the org type and format level.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Strong starter component: define the North Star, architect the ecosystem from where it is	ENFP-T starter, strongest 0 to 1	Moderate (has a build mandate, but within a large established org)
Variety vs. repetition	Strategic variety: multiple business units, diverse L&D challenges, AI tools evolution	Thrives on variety	Good
Autonomy level	High: owns the strategy and the team direction	Needs ownership, not execution-only	Good

Build vs. maintain	Build the learning ecosystem from current state to future vision	Builder identity	Good
Fractional fit	Full-time, office-first, Amsterdam. No fractional indication	Optimal: 2-3 concurrent 0.4-0.6 FTE	Poor - fractional conflict
Energy spike tolerance	Leading a team in a global org; front-loaded energy will be tested by org complexity	Front-loaded high energy, may read as overwhelming in political environments	Risky
Team size	Managing a team of Subject Matter Experts inside a 4,000-person org	Small team preference; large anonymous org is a penalty	Moderate

Flags: Fractional conflict. Full-time exclusivity expected. Large corporate slow decision cycles are a real risk at Adyen's matrix scale.

H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

The coaching and learning mandate is genuinely aligned with what Christiaan does for free (student counselling, unpaid guest lectures, mentoring startups). The facilitation identity fits the role. Adyen's mission (financial technology) is not intrinsically motivating - it is a vehicle, not a cause. The L&D mission within Adyen is more relevant: making people capable, designing learning that changes behavior. That dimension resonates.

This is not a role he would pursue for the domain (fintech), but the L&D-as-systems-design mandate is the kind of work he would do willingly at a dinner party. Partial genuine alignment, primarily around the coaching and learning architecture components.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers:

- Defining learning vision from scratch and building the team around it
- Coaching specialists and helping them reach potential
- Using modern learning technologies and AI applications in a real organizational context
- Cross-departmental stakeholder engagement and influence
- The "North Star" framing gives genuine ownership over the learning architecture

Likely drains:

- Full-time Amsterdam office: single-employer, fixed location, no fractional flexibility
- Global matrix complexity: navigating a 4,000+ person org with competing priorities and slow decision cycles
- L&D within HR function: tends to be politically cautious, incrementalist, and consensus-driven rather than experimental
- No green-field build from scratch: Adyen already has an L&D function; this is evolution of an existing system, not a new one
- Domain (fintech payment operations) generates no intrinsic energy

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Verdict: Short-term fit (stepping stone, valid reason)

The first 6-12 months have genuine build energy: defining the North Star, rebuilding the team's mandate, positioning L&D as strategic. This aligns with Christiaan's strongest phase. After the initial build, the role transitions into managing and maintaining the system he built inside a corporate structure. That is the ENFP plateau pattern. The full-time Amsterdam commitment also makes the multi-engagement model unsustainable. At 18 months, Christiaan would either have outgrown the scope or be feeling the drain of corporate maintenance mode. The role is a strong resume credential and a legitimate step, but not a long-term environment.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	No - genuine build mandate in first phase	Low initially, rising	Post-build the role becomes system management

Solo sales of an unready product	No	N/A	Not applicable
Full-time exclusivity expected	Yes	Medium	Office-first, no fractional option stated
Large corporate, slow decision cycles	Yes	Medium	4,000+ person matrix org; L&D in HR is historically slow to act
Governance/board role in declining org	No	N/A	Adyen is growing
Ceremony-only Scrum Master	No	N/A	Not an agile role

H7 - Fit Verdict

The honest case for this match:

This is the most strategically aligned role in the Adyen batch. The coaching mandate, the North Star framing, and the AI integration component all play to real Christiaan strengths. The L&D architecture work is genuine systems thinking, not content production. Adyen's quality as an employer, the seniority of the role, and the scope for impact make this a legitimate high-effort application. If Christiaan wants to build a corporate L&D leadership credential before moving into a more independent lab-builder role, this is a credible path.

The honest case against:

This is a full-time, office-first, large corporate role at a company in a domain that provides no intrinsic motivation. The multi-engagement model is incompatible. The global matrix structure will be frustrating for someone who reads the room fast and wants to act fast. The ENFP plateau hits after the initial build phase, likely within 12-18 months. The 2-year hackerspace vision is structurally incompatible with this trajectory unless Christiaan uses this role explicitly as a 2-year credential-building step and exits into independence. That is a valid strategy, but it needs to be conscious and deliberate.

Overall personality/culture fit: Conditional (conditional on treating this as a deliberate 2-year step, not a destination)

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

Learning & Development, L&D strategy, team lead, people management, learning ecosystem, leadership effectiveness, North Star vision, learning at scale, stakeholder influence, HR function, matrix organisation, modern learning technologies, AI applications, communities of practice, learner-centred, business enablement, frictionless experience, coaching, global L&D, programme leadership

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: Team Lead - Learning & Development

Location: Amsterdam

Department: Human Resources

Company: Adyen

This is Adyen

Adyen provides payments, data, and financial products in a single solution for customers like Meta, Uber, H&M, and Microsoft - making us the financial technology platform of choice. At Adyen, everything we do is engineered for ambition.

For our teams, we create an environment with opportunities for our people to succeed, backed by the culture and support to ensure they are enabled to truly own their careers. We are motivated individuals who tackle unique technical challenges at scale and solve them as a team. Together, we deliver innovative and ethical solutions that help businesses achieve their ambitions faster.

Team Lead - Learning & Development

The L&D Core team drives Adyen's global learning strategy through interventions, communities of practice, and advanced tooling. As Team Lead, you architect this ecosystem by leading Subject Matter Experts and defining the

strategic direction for learning at scale. Your work translates into "simple, unique, and bold" solutions aligned with company strategy.

What you'll do

- Define the North Star for 2026 strategy focused on strengthening leadership effectiveness and articulate long-term learning vision
- Build high-trust relationships across departments and communicate strategic rationale to stakeholders
- Position L&D Core as a primary organisational enablement driver integrated into key business groups
- Advocate for frictionless, learner-centred experiences that meet employees where they are
- Prioritise needle-moving projects solving real business problems
- Lead and coach team members to reach full potential while maintaining high performance standards
- Remove organisational friction to enable team delivery

Who you are

Required Experience

- Minimum 3 years managing teams of specialists in fast-paced tech or high-growth environments
- Deep expertise developing L&D programs within broader HR functions
- Ability to influence senior leadership across complex, global matrix organisations
- Proven track record translating business requirements into world-class learning strategies
- Comfort with modern learning technologies and demonstrating learning-business strategy connections

Our Diversity, Equity and Inclusion commitments

Our unique approach is a product of our diverse perspectives. This diversity of backgrounds and cultures is essential in helping us maintain our momentum. Our business and technical challenges are unique, and we need as many different voices as possible to join us in solving them - voices like yours. No matter who you are or where you're from, we welcome you to be your true self at Adyen.

Studies show that women and members of underrepresented communities apply for jobs only if they meet 100% of the qualifications. Does this sound like you? If so, Adyen encourages you to reconsider and apply. We look forward to your application!

What's next?

Ensuring a smooth and enjoyable candidate experience is critical for us. We aim to get back to you regarding your application within 5 business days. Our interview process tends to take about 4 weeks to complete, but may fluctuate depending on the role. Learn more about our hiring process [here](#). Don't be afraid to let us know if you need more flexibility.

This role is based out of our Amsterdam office. We are an office-first company and value in-person collaboration; we do not offer remote-only roles.